Susan Smith
We Love the Arts Council
4709 Kingsley Ave
Chicago, IL 60660

The Wildehouse Repertory Theatre believes artists can revolutionize communities! Our goal is to provide actors with sustainable resources by providing year-round housing and employment for one year as well as prioritizing and encouraging community engagement. By providing the most impactful, relevant, and interesting programming, we make a huge and lasting impact on our community.

By providing housing for our artists, we create a sustainable path for their year of steady employment at Wildehouse Repertory, an opportunity most actors and performers rarely receive. This alleviates the burden of locating housing individually and encourages a sense of belonging and camaraderie for our annual resident group of guest artists. We want everyone to feel welcome!

Our goal is to continue providing housing for all seasons going forward. Our actors have had a positive reaction to this style of housing and we intend to continue providing it for them. Its our way of making the lives easier for those who are continually contributing to the enrichment of our community through their artistry.

Wildehouse Repertory is seeking $26,400 to cover the cost of housing our actors for the 2025-2026 season, running May through May. We would love your support to continue offering this accommodation for our guest artists, as it enriches the quality of our work and benefits we are able to offer these amazing artists.

We hope you will join us in contributing to the housing of our artists for the 2025-2026 season. It will truly have a lasting impact on not only our organization itself, but the lives of the artists we are inviting into our community.

Thank you for your consideration,

Zachary Wilde
Wildehouse Repertory Theatre

Wildehouse Repertory Theatre

604 Franklin St.
Clarksville, TN 37040

Zachary Wilde, Director
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Wildehouse Repertory Theatre is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization.

Statement of Need
Wildehouse Repertory Theater is requesting $26,400 to cover the cost of housing our actors for the 2025-2026 season. The Tennessee Arts Commission has already gifted us $50,000 towards general operating costs to match the $26,400 request. One of our goals in supporting our mission in revolutionizing communities is to provide year-round housing for our year-round theatre company in order to provide our actors with sustainable resources. By providing our actors with permanent housing, it takes all of the pressure off of our actors in trying to find housing for the year as well as gives a sense of “home” for the duration of their time in our community.

Who We Serve

Wildehouse Repertory serves the community of Clarksville, Tennessee with a priority in community engagement and youth outreach. We are a company that uniquely operates year-round, with our actors being used in all productions. By providing year-round employment, we create a sustainable pathway for our artists and give them the opportunity for full time performance work, a rarity in the industry of live theatrical performance. A college town and military base, Clarksville covers a broad range of demographics which Wildehouse Rep actively tries to reflect in our programming. We have plans for a public performance this summer in the Downtown Commons, an opportunity to give back to our community by offering free photos with Santa this holiday season, and plans to partner with Austin Peay State University to host a theatre festival in the fall. By putting Clarksville first, we can guarantee programming that our community is interested in and wants to be a part of!

Our Board

Wildehouse Rep has a board of incredible local artists, educators, entrepreneurs, and professionals who have dedicated their time and resources to maintaining the integrity, values, and mission of the organization. Our board includes four tenured theatre/dance/tech professors who have served on many boards, a multiple-business owner, a city planner, a current technical director, a community engagement director, and a lawyer with decades of practice. Our board is committed to our organization and the artists it supports in every way from securing funding to signing checks. This grant would fulfill our need to continue supporting these artists by providing them with the housing they need for their duration of time with us.

Our Donors

Wildehouse Repertory has been fortunate enough to have generous donors who also believe in our mission that artists can revolutionize communities. Not only have we received over $100,000 in private donations, we have $300,000 of earned income between ticket & merchandise sales, and $55,000 in arts grants. The Tennessee Arts Commission has awarded us $50,000 towards general operating costs as well as $5,000 from the In These Mountains grant. We were donated the sets and costumes for the season as well as an ad company that has given us a billboard to use for advertising the season. As we continue to expand, so do our donors and partnerships because they believe in what we do!

About Us

Working full time as a professional actor can be very difficult. These passionate individuals have committed so much time to their craft, then spend the rest of their lives chasing employment. Wildehouse Repertory Theatre says “No more!”

Born out of the need to provide artists with the resources to improve their lives, Wildehouse Rep believes that artists can revolutionize communities. As a former professional actor and founder of Wildehouse Rep, Zachary Wilde firmly believes that by providing full time employment for artists, we can support them in a way that allows them to live with the stability they deserve. Gone are the days where the actors in our community are sending in endless self-tapes and audition reels! These talented people are artists with stories to tell and a community to engage.

Wildehouse Rep supports these artists and is committed to their futures and growth in their artistry.

At its inception, Wildehouse Repertory Theatre was a love letter to Amy Winehouse. Before her passing at the age of 27, Amy's struggles with substances and depression became a focal point of her career. So many artists fall into substance abuse and depression out of the fact that they have no expectations of sustainability in their lives. Actors are creatives. Creatives are our entrepreneurs, our voices, our challengers, our uniters. By uplifting these voices and giving them a place to call home, its just a matter of time until our community is thriving!

Speaking of community, this is paramount: everything we do at Wildehouse Rep goes right back into the community that we serve. We truly pride ourselves on engaging with the community and whether you're an actor, volunteer, community member, or ticket-buyer, you will feel our impact in a truly meaningful way. Our goal is to always fulfill our promise to choose varying pieces that our community wants to see.

We hope you will join us at Wildehouse Repertory Theatre and together we can revolutionize Clarksville and beyond!

Our Personnel

Zachary Wilde, Director

Zachary has 30 years of performance under his belt with a BFA in Musical Theatre Performance and is completing a Master's in Arts Leadership and Cultural Management in May of 2026. He is an educator and has had additional extensive experience in vocal pedagogy, music theory, children's theatre, and puppetry.

Kenny VanBuren, Stage Manager

Kenny has over 20 years of experience as a stage manager and designs lighting and sound for productions across the country as a guest artist. He has served on several boards and is an excellent resource for networking in our community.

Zoe Ruck, Scenic Designer

Zoe has a degree in Scenic Design from Austin Peay State University and was already being utilized by various companies before graduation. Her attention to forward-thinking, quick actions, and ability to create anything from nothing has been incredibly beneficial.

Katie Mullins, Office Manager

Katie has been managing a theater box office since 2001 and was responsible for writing all grant proposals for her last organization. She is a current board member of On The Rox Productions and has demonstrated the ability to assist our guests to accommodate all needs they may have time and time again.

Our Board

Kenny VanBuren

Kenny has over 20 years of experience and has been a constant participant in downtown voting activities.

Talon Bechard

Talon is a Theatre professor at APSU and has nearly 30 years of voiceover experience. He has been a member of this community for over 10 years and is an excellent source for industry contacts.

Sarah Randolph

Sarah is a retired tenured theatre professor from the University of Wisconsin system and mental health author & advocate. She taught theatre for over 40 years and has an incredible understanding of the inner workings of theatrical organizations.

Ashley Jones

Ashley has been the money manager for a booming restaurant in Nashville for nearly ten years. She has a finance degree and a strong sense of customer relationships.

Jess Sourbeer

Jess is a multiple-business owner and has been running three incredibly successful restaurant locations for nearly 15 years. She also possesses a culinary degree from Japan.

Matthew Powers

Matthew is a city planner for Montgomery County and has an excellent reputation as a forward-thinker in planning. He specializes in Placemaking and attends all local meetings. He will be an excellent resource for community outreach.

Ebone Johnson

Ebone is the Chair of the Dance department at APSU and holds a Doctorate in the field. She is a published dance author and teaches specialized classes nationwide. She will serve as our choreographer.

Nancy Albert

Nancy is a tenured Musical Theatre professor and has been in the area all her life. She is extremely connected with all theatre organizations in the area, as well as years of experience serving on theatrical boards.

Dale Tanner

Dale is currently the Director of Technical Theatre at APSU and organizes annual tech workshops. Dale would be our technical director, as she has the experience and creativity to make the magic come to life.

Javy Garland

Javy has served as the Community Engagement Coordinator for a nonprofit theatre in South Carolina and has recently moved to the area. He is an actor and has a real interest in children's programming.

Will Ernest

Will is a lawyer in town with Rogers, Williams, and Ernest and has many community ties. He specializes in nonprofit work and is incredibly knowledgeable of laws and practices from a legal standpoint.

Project Budget

Project: Artist housing, 2025-2026 season for all actors
Breakdown:

Lease: May 2025-May 2026
Cost: $2,200/month x 12 months= $26,400

Wildehouse Repertory full budget on following page.

WILDEHOUSE					

BUDGET 2026					
Revenue					In-Kind
Earned Income:					
	Ticket Sales		$	270,000	
	Merch Sales		$	30,000	
Ongoing Income:					
	Advertisement Sales		$	80,000	
Grants:					
	TAC Arts Access		$	50,000	
	In These Mtns.		$	5,000	
	We Love The Arts		$	**26,400**	
In Kind:					
	Adv. Sign		$		42,000
	Set Materials		$		7,000
	Costumes		$		6,000
Donations:					
	Birnbaum		$	45,000	
	VanBuren		$	73,600	
TOTALS				**580,000**	**55000**
Expenses					
Salaries:					
	Actors (FT)		$	230,400	
	Director (FT)		$	57,600	
	Stage Manager (FT)		$	48,000	
	Sets (FT)		$	48,000	
	Musicians (PT)		$	38,400	
	Office Manager (PT)		$	19,200	
Operational:					

	Space Rental		$	61,000	
	Housing Rental		$	26,400	
	Utilities		$	14,000	
	Music		$	12,000	
	Light & Sound Rental		$	12,000	
	Merchandise		$	9,000	
	Airfare		$	1,600	
	Office Materials		$	800	
	Outreach/Events		$	800	
	Video Licenses		$	800	
In Kind:					
	Advertising Sign		$		42,000
	Set Materials		$		7,000
	Costumes		$		6,000
TOTALS				**580,000**	**55000**